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Submitter Information

Name: Anonymous Anonymous

General Comment

While AI technology is helpful for some tasks there should be an extreme degree of consideration taken for data privacy in the training of these models. Up to this point it has been clear that AI companies have no concern for the ethics of the data they have. Many AI companies have swept the entirety of the internet and ingested nearly all accessible data to train their models giving no concern for the legality of the data they ingest or the copyright protections of said data. Now with this further order there is a great concern that people's private data will be used for training. It is not surprising that people do not want large corporations with no concerns for data privacy having access to information about them. If data ingested is retained without censorship it would in theory be possible to get the AI model to regurgitate part of said data as was done at a hacking convention with a car company's public chat bot instance of an AI model which was able to be tricked into revealing customers credit card numbers. In the rush to get investor money based on innovation in AI many companies have disregarded the ethics of what they do in favor of speed, we should not allow them access to private data as a reward for their actions.

Furthermore there are massive concerns as to the energy efficiency of these models. While our electricity infrastructure and generation ability continues to age we are developing technologies that require an extraordinary amount of power to perform basic tasks that AI was not previously used for. For example almost every basic google search now pops up Google's AI suggestion, because of this every google search now requires much more electricity to perform as well as more water to cool the computers. It is worth remembering that the resources used for things like this are limited to the electricity we can generate, the more we buy into it the more infrastructure will need to be generated making life more expensive for everyday Americans.

AI models can be useful, I do agree with that. AlphaFold 2 (the AI model that has been able to compute hundreds of millions of protein structures easily) has been revolutionary the past 2 years in Biology and we are making advances because of it. But these models are not ingesting private data, they only use known protein models and chemical information to train their system of calculators, and have real uses that benefit every human. It is dangerous to use successes like these to justify handing people's private information to a model for unknown benefits that would likely not help anybody and actively harm some people.